

Topic: **Life and Importance of Holy Prophet (PBUH): Life in Madinah.**

Sub Topic: **7th Year of Hijrah: Battle of Khyber.**

Q (a) Write about the main events of the battles of Khyber. [10]

Answer

- All 3 Jewish tribes broke the Charter of Madinah and were expelled one by one from the city of Prophet (PBUH). They settled in Khyber and continued their campaign against Islam. Their role in Battle of Trench, manipulating Ghatfan and other tribes against Islam and their long term planning of invading Madinah compelled Prophet (PBUH) to take action against them.
- Khyber was a heavily fortified territory approx. 95 miles north of Madinah and was famous for its agriculture.
- After Treaty of Hudaibiah when Quraysh's threat was neutralized for the time being, Prophet (PBUH) prepared to invade Khyber in 628 AD/7 A.H in the month of Muharram. He along with 1400 companions and 200 cavalry marched towards Khyber. His wife Umm-e-Salma (RA) was with him. Muslims took Jews by surprise and they had no option left except to lock themselves up in their forts.
- There were 8 famous forts distributed into 2 clusters.
 - 📍 Cluster 1 contained Fort Na'im, Fort Sa'ab bin Muaz, Fort Zubair, Fort Ubai and Fort Nizar.
 - 📍 Cluster 2 contained Fort Al-Qamus, Fort Watih and Fort Sulalim.Muslim army besieged Khyber and started attacking and infiltrating their defense lines one after another.
- Hazrat Ali (RA) was given the banner and special instructions by Holy Prophet (PBUH). He led the attack and infiltrated the first line of defense Fort Na'im. Jewish commander Marhab was killed by Ali (RA) while Zubair (RA) killed Marhab's brother Yasir.
- Jews abandoned Na'im fort and ran towards other forts. Habab bin Munzir (RA) captured Fort Sa'ab, Abu Dujana (RA) captured Fort Ubai. Fort Zubair was captured by cutting their water supply line and forcing them out to face Muslims. The walls of Fort Nizar were cracked by using catapults. Fort Qamus again was captured under the command of Hazrat Ali (RA) he smashed an immense door that required a group of people to be moved. Soon Jews surrendered the remaining forts and Muslims conquered the Khyber.
- 93 Jews were killed in Battle of Khyber while 15 Muslims got martyred.
- After the battle was over they plead to let them have Khyber. Prophet (PBUH) accepted on a condition that half harvest of Khyber will be given to Madinah on yearly basis as Jizyah (tax). Muslims got huge amount of spoils of wars.
- Prophet (PBUH) married Safiyah (RA) the daughter of Hayy bin Akhtab chief of Banu Nadhir.
- After the conquest of Khyber, a Jewish woman called Zainab bint Al-Harith offered the Prophet (PBUH) a roasted sheep she had poisoned. He took a mouthful, but it was not to his liking so he spat it out. After investigation, the woman confessed that she had stuffed the food with poison alleging that if the eater were a king, she would then rid herself of him, but should he be a Prophet, then he would be bound to learn about it. The Prophet (PBUH) ordered her execution after a companion named Bishr bin Bara' died of that poison.



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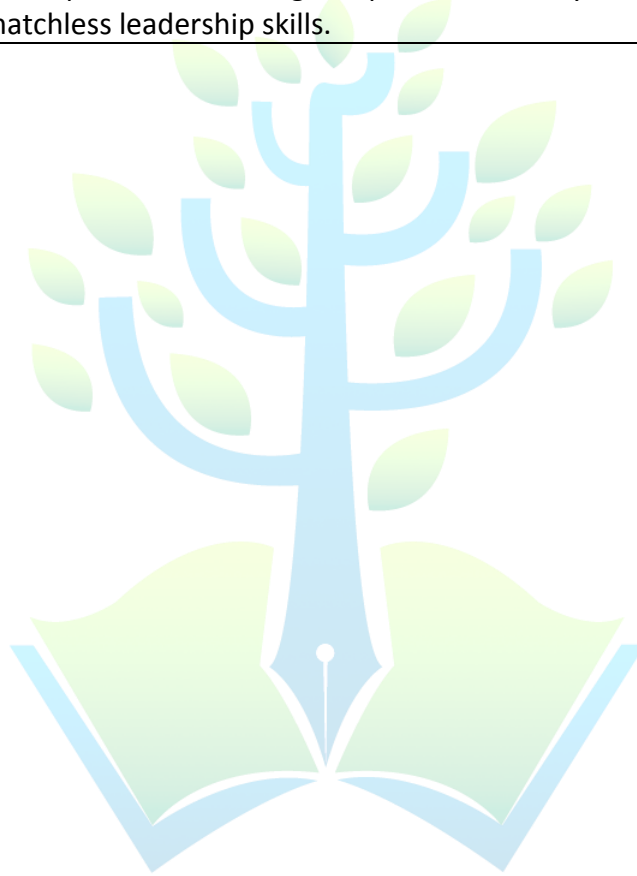


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Q (b) What was the significance of Battle of Khyber? [04]

Answer

- First Offensive Battle unlike all previous battles were in self-defense.
- Getting rid of Jewish conspiracies.
- Spoils of War that changed Muslims financial conditions.
- Prophet's (PBUH) trust got deeper after watching companions' bravery and Companions' morale was uplifted after seeing His matchless leadership skills.



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